

GOD IS A DICK

SINfully GOOD

A COOKBOOK OF SPECTACULARLY,
UNAPOLOGETICALLY NON-KOSHER FOOD



- I THOU SHALT
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- II THOU SHALT
MIX MEAT AND DAIRY
- III THOU SHALT
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HAVE NO REGRETS

— HOG SAMEACH —

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UNAPOLOGETICALLY NON-KOSHER FOOD

— HOG SAMEACH —

GOD IS A DICK: SINfully Good
A Cookbook of Spectacularly, Unapologetically Non-Kosher Food

First edition. There will not be a second, for reasons that will become
apparent.

No animals were spared in the making of this book.

The author accepts no responsibility for cholesterol, guilt, arguments at the
table, or the facial expression of anyone's mother upon being handed the
Lobster Gefilte Fish.

All recipes were tested. Repeatedly. Enthusiastically. At considerable
personal cost.

Printed on paper. Eaten over the sink.

"There was really no reason to do this."

— the entire thesis of this book, stated early, so nobody can claim they
weren't warned

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A Note From the Author

who is going to hell and has made peace with it

Every cuisine on earth is a record of what people had. Jewish cuisine is a record of what people were told they couldn't have, cooked around, and then made delicious anyway out of pure spite. That is an extraordinary achievement. It is also, if you think about it for more than four seconds, an enormous amount of unnecessary work.

Consider the situation. An omniscient being creates the pig — an animal that converts garbage into the single most useful fat in the culinary canon — and then puts up a rope in front of it. He fills the sea with lobsters, which are essentially butter delivery vehicles with legs, and says no. He invents both the cow and the dairy the cow produces, and then rules that the two may never meet. This is not a dietary code. This is a tease.

Somewhere in the Ancient Near East, a very good cook took one look at all this and thought: fine. Fine! And then went and invented brisket.

This book is what happens on the other side of that rope. Every recipe in it breaks kashrut on purpose, and — this part matters — breaks it for a reason. Bacon fat is here because it makes challah custard taste like the best morning of your life, not because it's transgressive. Lobster meets guanciale because the guanciale seasons the water the pasta finishes in, and the lobster wants exactly that. Shellfish and pork and dairy are not the punchline. They are the technique.

You will notice that the food in here is, structurally, extremely Jewish. It is braised for a long time. It is fried in a great deal of fat. It is served in quantities that suggest the

cook does not believe you when you say you already ate. That is not an accident and it is not an apology. This is a Jewish cookbook. It's just one where nobody is calling the rabbi first.

A word on the title. It is affectionate. Anyone who has spent a lifetime inside a tradition that argues with its own God on a first-name basis will recognize the tone immediately. We are not renouncing anything. We are kvetching, which is the highest form of belonging.

Cook something. Feed people. Go outside afterward, because you will need to.

How to Use This Book

The Commandments Broken sidebar.

Every recipe is labeled with which rules it violates: Pork, Shellfish, Meat + Dairy, and — the category that does the most heavy lifting in this book — Questionable Judgment. Use these to plan a menu, or to decide how much you're willing to explain later.

Fat is an ingredient, not an accident.

Bacon fat, schmaltz, lard, butter, beef tallow. Keep bacon fat in a jar in the fridge; you will need it constantly and it will outlast several of your relationships. Render it yourself. Store-bought is fine but tastes like a compromise.

Salt as you go.

Not at the end. At every stage. This is the single largest gap between food that is good and food that people talk about in the car on the way home.

Temperature matters more than timing.

Every time listed here is an estimate written by someone who does not know your oven. Buy an instant-read thermometer. It costs less than one bad brisket.

Do not substitute the thing that makes it work.

You may swap the cheese. You may not remove the cheese. If you find yourself asking whether the dish is still good without the pork, the answer is that it becomes a different dish, and that dish has a name, and its name is not in this book.

Feed people.

None of this is portioned for one. That's deliberate. The whole point of a forbidden meal is that you have witnesses.

The Pantry of the Fallen

Bacon fat

Rendered from thick-cut smoked bacon. Strain it hot through a coffee filter, keep it cold, use it everywhere. It is the schmaltz of the other side.

Guanciale

Cured pork jowl. Fattier, funkier, and more forgiving than pancetta. Renders into a fat that is essentially a sauce base with no further work required.

Good challah

Day-old is better than fresh for anything custard-related. A challah that is slightly past its prime absorbs like a sponge and fries like a dream.

Gruyère

The most useful melting cheese on earth. Nutty, salty, browns beautifully, refuses to go greasy. Buy the block, grate it yourself.

Manischewitz

Yes, really. Cooked down, it becomes a glaze with the structure of a good port reduction and the sweetness of a fortified grape syrup. It was always a cooking wine. We were all just too polite to say so.

Beef tallow

For frying potatoes. There is no third-place finisher; it is tallow, then duck fat, then a long sad gap.

Smoked paprika

Pimentón de la Vera, sweet or hot. Does about 40% of the work in this book's Spanish-adjacent recipes and asks for nothing in return.

Crème fraîche and sour cream

Both are here to sit next to meat, which is the whole reason they're on this list.

Kosher salt

The irony is noted. Use it anyway — the crystal size is right and the brand is not actually doing anything religious to your food.

PART I

In the Beginning, There Was Bacon



Before anything else, there was a pig, and the pig was good, and somebody looked at it and said absolutely not.

This chapter is the foundation of everything that follows, because bacon fat is the foundation of everything that follows. It is not a garnish. It is a cooking medium with an opinion — smoky, salty, faintly sweet, and structurally superior to butter for anything that needs to get crisp and stay crisp. Render a pound of it now and keep it in a jar. You will use it in six chapters and you will stop asking why.

Start here. Learn what the fat does. The rest of the book assumes you already know.

Bacon-Fat Challah French Toast

SERVES 4 • 30 MINUTES, PLUS OVERNIGHT FOR THE BREAD

Challah is the perfect French toast bread and has been the whole time — enriched, eggy, structurally sturdy, engineered by generations of bakers to absorb custard without collapsing into porridge. The only thing it was ever missing was the correct fat to fry it in.

The trick here is that bacon fat goes into the custard as well as the pan. Warm fat whisked into eggs and cream carries smoke into the interior of the bread instead of leaving it on the surface. The result tastes like the best diner you've ever been to, run by your grandmother, in a version of the world where nobody's watching.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz thick-cut smoked bacon
- 1 loaf challah, cut into 1¼-inch slices, left uncovered overnight
- 4 large eggs
- 1 cup heavy cream
- ½ cup whole milk
- 3 tbsp light brown sugar
- 1½ tsp vanilla extract
- ½ tsp cinnamon
- ¼ tsp freshly grated nutmeg
- ½ tsp kosher salt

For the salted maple butter

- 6 tbsp unsalted butter, softened
- 3 tbsp real maple syrup, plus more for serving
- ½ tsp flaky sea salt

METHOD

1. Lay the bacon in a cold, heavy skillet and set it over medium-low heat. Cook slowly, turning occasionally, 12 to 15 minutes, until deeply crisp. Transfer to paper towels. Pour off the fat and reserve it — you should have about $\frac{1}{3}$ cup. Wipe the pan.
2. Whisk the eggs, cream, milk, brown sugar, vanilla, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt in a wide dish until completely smooth. While whisking, stream in 2 tablespoons of the warm — not hot — bacon fat. It will emulsify into the custard and go slightly glossy.
3. Whip the softened butter with the maple syrup and flaky salt until light. Set aside at room temperature.
4. Soak the challah slices in the custard, 45 seconds per side. Day-old bread will drink it; fresh bread will fall apart, which is why we waited.
5. Heat $1\frac{1}{2}$ tablespoons of the reserved bacon fat in the skillet over medium. Fry the slices in batches, 3 to 4 minutes per side, until the crust is mahogany and the center is set. Add fat between batches.
6. Serve immediately with a slab of the maple butter melting into the top, the bacon crumbled over, and more syrup than you think is reasonable.

A note: *If your bacon renders less than $\frac{1}{3}$ cup, your bacon was a disappointment and you should change brands.*

Pork Belly Shakshuka

SERVES 4 · 3 HOURS, MOSTLY UNATTENDED

Shakshuka is a sauce looking for something rich to happen to it. Traditionally that richness comes from egg yolk and a crumble of feta at the end. Here it arrives earlier and with considerably more confidence.

The pork belly is roasted separately until the fat has surrendered and the exterior is lacquered, then set into the sauce at the last minute so it stays crisp. Do not braise it in the tomatoes. That way lies a very good stew and a betrayal of the concept.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 1½ lb skin-on pork belly, cut into 1½-inch cubes
- 1 tbsp kosher salt
- 2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 large yellow onion, sliced thin
- 2 red bell peppers, sliced into strips
- 5 garlic cloves, sliced
- 1 tbsp harissa, or 1 tsp red pepper flakes
- 1 tsp ground caraway
- One 28-oz can whole peeled tomatoes, crushed by hand
- 1 tsp sugar
- 6 large eggs
- Cilantro, parsley, and warm pita or challah, for serving

METHOD

- 1.** Heat the oven to 300°F. Toss the pork belly with the salt, smoked paprika, and cumin. Arrange fat-side up in a small roasting pan and roast for 2 hours, until the fat is soft and translucent.
- 2.** Raise the heat to 450°F and roast 20 to 25 minutes more, until the outside is crackling and dark. Remove and keep warm. Reserve 2 tablespoons of the rendered fat from the pan.
- 3.** In a 12-inch skillet, heat the olive oil with the reserved pork fat over medium. Cook the onion and peppers with a big pinch of salt for 15 minutes, until slumped and sweet. Add the garlic, harissa, and caraway; cook 2 minutes more.
- 4.** Add the tomatoes and sugar. Simmer 25 to 30 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the sauce is thick enough that a spoon dragged across the pan leaves a trail. Taste and salt aggressively.
- 5.** Make six wells in the sauce and crack an egg into each. Cover and cook 6 to 8 minutes, until the whites are just set and the yolks still move.
- 6.** Tuck the pork belly cubes in among the eggs. Scatter with herbs and bring the pan to the table with the bread.

Prosciutto-Wrapped Dates with Goat Cheese

SERVES 6 AS AN APPETIZER · 25 MINUTES

There is no cleverness here whatsoever. Sweet, salty, creamy, pork. It is the single most efficient way to violate two rules in under twenty minutes and it will disappear off the tray faster than anything else you make.

Medjool dates only. The dry supermarket kind will turn to leather in the oven and the whole thing becomes a lesson rather than a snack.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 20 Medjool dates, pitted
- 5 oz soft goat cheese, at room temperature
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- Black pepper
- 10 slices prosciutto di Parma, halved lengthwise
- Honey and flaky salt, for finishing

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400°F and line a sheet pan with parchment.
2. Mash the goat cheese with the thyme and a generous grind of black pepper. Spoon or pipe about 1½ teaspoons into each date and press it closed.
3. Wrap each date in a half-slice of prosciutto, seam-side down on the pan.

4. Roast 12 to 14 minutes, until the prosciutto has tightened and gone crisp at the edges and the cheese is bubbling at the seams.
5. Rest 5 minutes — the interior is molten sugar and will do real damage — then drizzle with honey and finish with flaky salt.

Chorizo Matzo Brei

SERVES 2 • 20 MINUTES

Matzo brei is a dish invented to make the bread of affliction edible. It has always been about rescue. All we're doing is bringing in better equipment.

Spanish chorizo — the cured, firm kind, not the fresh Mexican variety — renders an orange, paprika-stained fat that soaks into the softened matzo and turns the whole thing a color that can only be described as incriminating.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 4 sheets matzo
- 4 oz cured Spanish chorizo, diced small
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- ½ small onion, diced
- 1 red bell pepper, diced
- 5 large eggs, beaten with 2 tbsp water
- 2 oz Manchego, grated
- Kosher salt, black pepper
- Chopped parsley

METHOD

1. Break the matzo into rough 2-inch pieces into a colander. Run warm water over them for about 10 seconds — enough to soften, not enough to dissolve. Drain and let sit.
2. In a 10-inch nonstick skillet, cook the chorizo in the olive oil over medium heat for 4 minutes, until the fat runs bright orange and the edges crisp. Add the onion and pepper and cook 6 minutes more.

- 3.** Add the drained matzo and toss for 2 minutes so every piece takes on the fat.
- 4.** Season the eggs with salt and pepper and pour them in. Let them sit for 20 seconds, then fold slowly and continuously with a rubber spatula until just barely set — they will keep cooking off the heat.
- 5.** Kill the heat, fold in the Manchego, and let it melt for 30 seconds. Top with parsley and eat straight from the pan.

The BLT That Requires a Nap

SERVES 2, BADLY • 25 MINUTES

A BLT is only ever as good as its worst component, which is why most of them are ruined by the tomato. Make this in August or don't make it at all.

The two upgrades that matter: the brioche is toasted in bacon fat rather than butter, and the mayonnaise is doctored with raw garlic and lemon until it has an actual point of view. The nap is not optional and is not a joke.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork • Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 8 slices thick-cut smoked bacon
- 4 thick slices brioche or good white bread
- 1 large heirloom tomato, sliced ½-inch thick
- 4 leaves butter lettuce
- Flaky salt, black pepper

For the garlic mayo

- ½ cup good mayonnaise
- 1 small garlic clove, grated on a microplane
- 1 tsp lemon juice
- ¼ tsp black pepper

METHOD

1. Cook the bacon slowly in a cold skillet over medium-low, 12 to 15 minutes, until rigid and dark. Drain on paper towels; reserve the fat.
2. Stir together the mayo, garlic, lemon juice, and pepper. Let it sit 10 minutes so the garlic mellows from harsh into present.

3. Salt the tomato slices on both sides and lay them on paper towels for 10 minutes. This concentrates them and keeps the sandwich from flooding.
4. Toast the bread in 2 tablespoons of the bacon fat over medium heat until golden and slightly crunchy at the edges.
5. Build: mayo on both slices, lettuce down first as a moisture barrier, tomato, a heavy grind of pepper and flaky salt, then four slices of bacon arranged so every bite gets some. Close, cut on the diagonal, and clear your afternoon.

PART II

Thou Shalt Not Boil a Kid in Its Mother's Milk



This is the strangest rule of the lot, because it is the one that had to be extrapolated. One sentence, repeated three times, about a specific act of cruelty involving one goat — and from it, an entire architecture of separate dishes, separate sinks, separate drying racks, and a waiting period after the brisket during which you may not have ice cream.

Whatever the original intent, the practical outcome was to remove from Jewish cooking the single most reliable flavor combination in Western cuisine: roasted meat and warm dairy. Butter on steak. Cream in the pan after the braise. Cheese melting over anything at all.

This chapter puts it back. Every recipe here is built on the same insight — that fat and acid from dairy do something to meat that nothing else does, which is why the rest of the world figured this out and never stopped.

Short Rib Mac & Cheese

SERVES 6 TO 8 • 4 HOURS

Braised beef and a cheese sauce are two separately magnificent things that were never legally permitted to be introduced. Together they produce a dish that is roughly 40% of the reason this book exists.

The critical move is finishing the pasta in the reduced braising liquid before the béchamel goes in. That way the beef flavor is inside the noodles rather than sitting in a puddle underneath them.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

For the short ribs

- 3 lb bone-in beef short ribs
- Kosher salt, black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 carrots, chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, smashed
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 1½ cups dry red wine
- 3 cups beef stock
- 2 bay leaves, 4 thyme sprigs

For the assembly

- 1 lb cavatappi or elbows
- 4 tbsp unsalted butter
- ¼ cup all-purpose flour
- 3 cups whole milk, warmed
- 8 oz Gruyère, grated

- 8 oz sharp cheddar, grated
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- ¼ tsp freshly grated nutmeg
- 1 cup panko tossed with 2 tbsp melted butter

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 325°F. Season the short ribs hard on all sides. Sear in the oil in a Dutch oven over high heat until darkly crusted, about 3 minutes a side. Remove.
2. Cook the onion, carrots, and garlic in the fat for 8 minutes. Stir in the tomato paste and let it darken for 2 minutes. Deglaze with the wine, scraping the bottom, and reduce by half.
3. Return the ribs, add the stock and herbs, cover, and braise 3 hours, until the meat gives way completely. Shred the meat, discarding bones and fat. Strain the liquid and reduce it over high heat to about 1 cup.
4. Boil the pasta 2 minutes shy of al dente. Drain and return it to the pot with the reduced braising liquid; toss over low heat for 2 minutes until absorbed.
5. Make the béchamel: melt the butter, whisk in the flour, cook 2 minutes without color, then stream in the warm milk. Simmer, whisking, until it coats a spoon. Off heat, add both cheeses in handfuls, the Dijon, and the nutmeg. Season.
6. Fold the sauce and the shredded beef into the pasta. Scrape into a buttered 9×13 dish, top with the buttered panko, and bake at 400°F for 20 to 25 minutes, until bubbling and brown. Rest 10 minutes.

Cheeseburger with Everything

SERVES 4 • 35 MINUTES

The cheeseburger is the most efficient religious violation available to the general public, and it is also, on a good day, one of the best things anyone has ever built. Two thin patties instead of one thick one, because the crust is the entire product.

Do not press the patty after the crust forms. You spent all that effort making it and you're squeezing it out onto the griddle like a person who has learned nothing.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy · Pork

INGREDIENTS

- 1½ lb ground beef, 80/20, divided into 8 loose 3-oz balls
- 8 slices American cheese
- 8 slices bacon, cooked crisp
- 4 potato buns, split
- 3 tbsp unsalted butter, softened
- Thinly sliced white onion, pickle chips, shredded iceberg
- Kosher salt, black pepper

For the special sauce

- ½ cup mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp ketchup
- 1 tbsp yellow mustard
- 2 tbsp finely chopped dill pickle
- 1 tsp pickle brine
- ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ¼ tsp garlic powder

METHOD

- 1.** Stir all the sauce ingredients together and refrigerate at least 20 minutes.
- 2.** Butter the cut sides of the buns and toast them face-down in a skillet until golden. Set aside.
- 3.** Get a cast-iron skillet or flat griddle ripping hot. Place two beef balls in the dry pan and immediately smash each flat with a stiff spatula, hard, for a full 10 seconds. Season the tops with salt and pepper.
- 4.** Cook 90 seconds without touching, until the edges are lace-brown and crisp. Flip, lay a slice of cheese on each, and cook 45 seconds more.
- 5.** Stack two patties per bun. Add bacon, onion, pickles, lettuce, and a heavy swipe of sauce on both bun halves.
- 6.** Press the top down gently, wait 60 seconds for everything to settle into itself, and eat over a plate.

Lamb Moussaka with Parmesan Béchamel

SERVES 8 • 2 ½ HOURS

Moussaka is a three-part construction project and the payoff is entirely worth the afternoon. Salting and roasting the eggplant — rather than frying it — keeps the layers distinct instead of turning the whole pan into an oil slick.

The béchamel is enriched with egg yolks and a great deal of Parmesan, which lets it set into a proper custard top rather than a sauce that has given up.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 3 medium eggplants, sliced ½-inch thick
- Olive oil, kosher salt
- 2 lb ground lamb
- 1 large onion, diced
- 4 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 1 tsp cinnamon, 1 tsp dried oregano, ½ tsp allspice
- ½ cup dry red wine
- One 28-oz can crushed tomatoes

For the béchamel

- 6 tbsp butter
- 6 tbsp flour
- 3½ cups whole milk, warmed
- 3 egg yolks
- 1½ cups grated Parmesan
- ½ tsp nutmeg

METHOD

- 1.** Salt the eggplant slices and lay them on racks for 45 minutes. Blot dry, brush with olive oil, and roast at 425°F for 25 minutes, flipping once, until golden and pliable.
- 2.** Brown the lamb hard in a wide pot, breaking it up. Drain off all but 2 tablespoons of fat. Add the onion and cook 8 minutes, then the garlic, tomato paste, and spices; cook 2 minutes.
- 3.** Add the wine, scrape the pot, reduce by half, then add the tomatoes. Simmer uncovered 35 minutes until thick and glossy. Season well.
- 4.** For the béchamel, cook the butter and flour 2 minutes, whisk in the milk, and simmer until thick. Off heat, temper in the yolks, then the Parmesan and nutmeg.
- 5.** Layer in a deep 9×13: eggplant, all the lamb, eggplant, then the entire béchamel smoothed over the top.
- 6.** Bake at 350°F for 45 to 50 minutes until the top is puffed and deeply spotted. Rest 30 minutes before cutting or it will not hold its shape and you will be sad in front of guests.

Steak au Poivre with Blue-Cheese Cream

SERVES 2 · 30 MINUTES

Steak au Poivre is already a meat dish finished in cream, which was more than enough. Adding blue cheese to the pan sauce is greed. It is also, unfortunately, correct.

Crack the peppercorns yourself in a mortar or under a heavy pan. Pre-ground pepper has no volatile oils left and the crust will taste like dust.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- Two 10-oz strip steaks, 1¼ inches thick, at room temperature
- 2 tbsp black peppercorns, coarsely cracked
- Kosher salt
- 1 tbsp neutral oil
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter
- 2 shallots, minced
- ⅓ cup Cognac or brandy
- ¾ cup heavy cream
- 3 oz Roquefort or Stilton, crumbled
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard

METHOD

1. Pat the steaks bone dry. Salt them generously, then press the cracked pepper firmly into both sides.
2. Sear in the oil in a heavy skillet over high heat, 3 to 4 minutes per side for medium-rare (125°F). Add the butter for the last minute and baste. Rest on a board.

- 3.** Lower the heat to medium. Cook the shallots in the pan fat for 2 minutes.
- 4.** Off the heat, add the Cognac. Return to the flame and let it reduce to a syrup, scraping up everything stuck to the pan.
- 5.** Add the cream and simmer 3 minutes. Whisk in the blue cheese and Dijon until melted and just thick enough to coat. Do not boil it after the cheese goes in.
- 6.** Pour any resting juices into the sauce, slice the steaks against the grain, and spoon the sauce over the top.

Brisket Grilled Cheese

SERVES 2 • 30 MINUTES

The traditional destiny of leftover brisket is a sandwich the next day, cold, standing at the refrigerator, in the dark, alone. This is that sandwich if someone loved you.

Mayonnaise on the outside of the bread instead of butter. It browns more evenly, has a higher smoke point, and no one has ever detected it. Butter goes inside, on the brisket, where it belongs.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz smoked or braised brisket, sliced thin
- 2 tbsp braising liquid or beef stock
- 1 large yellow onion, sliced thin
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter
- Pinch of sugar, kosher salt
- 4 thick slices seeded rye
- 6 oz sharp cheddar, grated
- 2 oz Gruyère, grated
- 2 tbsp mayonnaise
- 1 tbsp whole-grain mustard

METHOD

1. Cook the onion in the butter over medium-low with the sugar and a pinch of salt, stirring every few minutes, for 30 minutes, until jammy and brown. Set aside.
2. Warm the brisket gently in a skillet with the braising liquid until just heated through — do not let it dry out.

3. Spread mustard on the inside of two slices of rye. Build each sandwich: cheddar, brisket, onions, Gruyère, top slice. The cheese must touch both slices or the structure fails.
4. Spread mayonnaise on the outsides.
5. Cook in a dry skillet over medium-low, covered, 4 to 5 minutes per side. Low and slow — you need the cheese fully molten before the bread is done, and rushing this is the only way to ruin it.
6. Cut in half and eat while the cheese still pulls.

PART III

Creatures of the Sea That God Apparently Had Opinions About



Fins and scales. That's the whole test. Everything else in the ocean — the lobster, the crab, the oyster, the scallop, the shrimp — was sorted into a category best translated as 'swarming thing,' which is not a flattering description of an animal that tastes like sweet butter and costs forty dollars a pound.

There is a defensible public-health argument buried in here somewhere involving the Bronze Age and inadequate refrigeration. There is no defensible argument for continuing to skip a properly fried oyster in a city with functioning cold chains.

A note on sourcing, since it actually matters more here than anywhere else in the book: shellfish is the one category where freshness is not a preference but a structural requirement. Buy it from someone who can tell you what day it came in. If they can't, make something from Part I instead.

Lobster Mac & Cheese

SERVES 6 • 1 HOUR 15 MINUTES

The mistake most people make is treating the lobster as a topping. It should be poached in butter, folded through at the last possible moment, and never allowed anywhere near the oven, where it will seize into expensive erasers.

Use the shells. Simmering them in the milk before you build the béchamel is fifteen minutes of work that changes the dish from 'mac and cheese with lobster in it' to 'lobster mac and cheese.'

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Shellfish · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- Two 1½-lb lobsters, steamed 8 minutes, meat picked, shells reserved
- 3 cups whole milk
- 1 lb cavatappi
- 6 tbsp unsalted butter, divided
- ¼ cup all-purpose flour
- 8 oz Gruyère, grated
- 6 oz white cheddar, grated
- 2 oz mascarpone
- 1 tsp Dijon, ¼ tsp cayenne, ¼ tsp nutmeg
- 1 cup panko, 2 tbsp butter, 2 tbsp chopped tarragon
- Kosher salt, white pepper

METHOD

1. Crush the lobster shells and simmer them in the milk over low heat for 20 minutes. Strain and discard the shells. You now have lobster milk, which is the entire point.

- 2.** Cut the lobster meat into $\frac{3}{4}$ -inch pieces. Melt 3 tablespoons of butter in a small pan over low heat and turn the meat in it for 90 seconds — just warmed, not cooked. Remove from heat.
- 3.** Boil the pasta 2 minutes shy of al dente and drain.
- 4.** Melt the remaining 3 tablespoons of butter, whisk in the flour, cook 2 minutes, then stream in the warm lobster milk. Simmer until thickened.
- 5.** Off heat, melt in the Gruyère, cheddar, and mascarpone. Add Dijon, cayenne, and nutmeg. Season with salt and white pepper.
- 6.** Fold the sauce into the pasta, then fold in the lobster and its butter. Transfer to a buttered dish, top with the panko tossed with butter and tarragon, and bake at 425°F for 15 minutes only — long enough to brown the top, short enough to spare the lobster.

Shrimp Scampi over Fresh Pasta

SERVES 4 • 25 MINUTES

Fifteen minutes, six ingredients, and the outcome depends almost entirely on your willingness to pull the shrimp off the heat before you think they're ready. They are ready. They will finish in the sauce.

The other thing nobody does: shell the shrimp yourself and let the shells sizzle in the butter for two minutes first. Then fish them out. Free flavor, zero cost.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Shellfish · Meat + Dairy is technically avoided here, which is the only restraint in this book

INGREDIENTS

- 1½ lb large shrimp, peeled and deveined, shells reserved
- 6 tbsp unsalted butter, divided
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 8 garlic cloves, sliced paper-thin
- ½ tsp red pepper flakes
- ¾ cup dry white wine
- Juice and zest of 1 lemon
- 1 lb fresh linguine or tagliatelle
- ½ cup chopped flat-leaf parsley
- Kosher salt, black pepper

METHOD

1. Melt 2 tablespoons of butter in a large skillet over medium-high. Add the shrimp shells and cook 3 minutes until bright pink and fragrant. Remove and discard the shells.
2. Bring a large pot of well-salted water to a boil.

- 3.** Add the olive oil to the skillet, then the garlic and pepper flakes. Cook over medium-low for 3 minutes — the garlic should go pale gold and sweet. Brown garlic is bitter garlic.
- 4.** Raise the heat, add the wine, and reduce by half. Add the shrimp in a single layer, season, and cook 1 minute per side. Pull them out onto a plate the moment they curl.
- 5.** Drop the pasta; fresh pasta needs 2 to 3 minutes. Reserve a cup of the water.
- 6.** Off heat, whisk the remaining 4 tablespoons of butter into the pan sauce a piece at a time with a splash of pasta water until it turns glossy and thick. Add the lemon juice and zest.
- 7.** Return the shrimp, add the drained pasta and the parsley, and toss hard for 30 seconds, adding pasta water until the sauce clings. Serve immediately.

Crab Benedict

SERVES 4 • 45 MINUTES

Brunch is the most forgiving meal of the week and this is the reason. A crab cake that is 90% crab and 10% structural obligation, a poached egg, and a hollandaise that you will make by hand because the blender version breaks and you know it.

The single biggest sin in crab cakes is filler. If you can taste the breadcrumb, you have made a hushpuppy with ambitions.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Shellfish · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

For the crab cakes

- 1 lb jumbo lump crabmeat, picked over gently
- ⅓ cup mayonnaise
- 1 egg
- 1 tsp Dijon, 1 tsp Old Bay, 1 tsp Worcestershire
- 2 tbsp chopped chives
- ⅓ cup panko
- 2 tbsp butter and 1 tbsp oil, for frying

For the hollandaise and assembly

- 3 egg yolks
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 1 cup clarified butter, warm
- Pinch of cayenne, kosher salt
- 8 eggs, for poaching
- 1 tbsp white vinegar
- 4 English muffins, split and toasted

METHOD

1. Whisk the mayo, egg, Dijon, Old Bay, Worcestershire, and chives together. Fold in the crab and panko with a rubber spatula using as few strokes as possible — you want lumps intact. Form eight cakes and chill 20 minutes.
2. Make the hollandaise: whisk the yolks and lemon juice in a metal bowl over barely simmering water until pale, thick, and doubled, about 3 minutes. Off the heat, drizzle in the warm clarified butter, whisking constantly, until emulsified. Season with cayenne and salt. Keep it somewhere warm but not hot.
3. Fry the crab cakes in the butter and oil over medium heat, 3 to 4 minutes a side, until deeply golden. Do not move them early.
4. Poach the eggs in barely simmering water with the vinegar, 3 minutes for a runny yolk.
5. Build: muffin half, crab cake, poached egg, a heavy pour of hollandaise. Dust with Old Bay and more chives.

A note: *If the hollandaise breaks, whisk a fresh yolk with a teaspoon of water in a clean bowl and dribble the broken sauce into it. It comes back. Nobody has to know.*

Crispy Oyster Po' Boy

SERVES 4 • 40 MINUTES

The correct oyster po' boy is an exercise in contrast: hot, craggy, cornmeal-crusted oysters against cold shredded lettuce and cool remoulade, all of it inside bread that shatters on the outside and is essentially air on the inside.

Fry in small batches. Crowding the pot drops the oil temperature and you will produce something greasy and pale, which is a waste of a perfectly good oyster and a perfectly good afternoon.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Shellfish · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

For the remoulade

- 1 cup mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp Creole mustard
- 1 tbsp prepared horseradish
- 1 tbsp hot sauce, 2 tsp lemon juice
- 1 tsp smoked paprika, 2 scallions minced, 1 garlic clove grated

For the oysters

- 24 shucked oysters, drained
- 1 cup fine cornmeal
- ½ cup all-purpose flour
- 1 tbsp Cajun seasoning, 1 tsp salt, ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 cup buttermilk
- Neutral oil, for frying
- 2 baguettes or 4 lengths of soft French bread
- Shredded iceberg, sliced tomato, pickle chips, hot sauce

METHOD

1. Stir all the remoulade ingredients together and refrigerate.
2. Heat 2 inches of oil in a heavy pot to 375°F.
3. Whisk the cornmeal, flour, Cajun seasoning, salt, and pepper in a shallow dish. Soak the drained oysters in the buttermilk, then lift them out and dredge, pressing the coating on.
4. Fry six at a time for 90 seconds to 2 minutes, until crisp and golden. Drain on a rack — never paper towels, which steam the bottoms — and salt immediately.
5. Split the bread and toast the cut sides. Spread remoulade thickly on both halves.
6. Layer lettuce, tomato, pickles, then the oysters straight from the fryer. Hot sauce, close, press, cut.

Scallops with Bacon Beurre Blanc

SERVES 4 • 30 MINUTES

Shellfish, pork, and an obscene quantity of butter, plated in a way that suggests you know what you're doing. This is the recipe in the book with the highest ratio of impressiveness to actual effort, and it is finished in under half an hour.

The sear is the entire dish. Dry scallops, hot pan, no movement. If the scallop sticks, it is not ready to be flipped; it will release itself when the crust has formed. Trust the scallop.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Shellfish · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 16 large dry-packed sea scallops, side muscle removed
- 6 oz slab bacon, cut into small lardons
- Kosher salt, white pepper
- 2 shallots, minced
- ½ cup dry white wine
- 2 tbsp white wine vinegar
- 3 tbsp heavy cream
- 10 tbsp cold unsalted butter, cubed
- 1 tbsp chopped chives
- Lemon

METHOD

1. Render the bacon in a skillet over medium heat until crisp, 8 minutes. Lift out the lardons; pour off all but 2 tablespoons of fat and reserve the rest.
2. Pat the scallops completely dry — press them between paper towels for a full minute. Season with salt and white pepper.

3. Sear in the bacon fat over high heat, without touching, for 2 minutes, until a deep brown crust forms. Flip, cook 60 to 90 seconds more, and remove. They should still be translucent at the very center.
4. Wipe the pan. Simmer the shallots, wine, and vinegar over medium heat until reduced to about 2 tablespoons of syrup.
5. Add the cream, then whisk in the cold butter one cube at a time, never letting the sauce boil, until it is thick and pale. Strain if you want it elegant; don't if you don't. Season.
6. Spoon the sauce onto warm plates, set four scallops on each, scatter the bacon and chives over, and finish with a small squeeze of lemon.

PART IV

Multiple Infractions



Up to this point we have been breaking rules one and two at a time, like amateurs.

The recipes in this chapter are engineered to violate several categories simultaneously, and the reason they work — the reason they are not merely stunts — is that the violations reinforce each other. Pork fat seasons shellfish better than butter does. Cheese binds shellfish and pork into something that holds together on a plate. Every combination in this chapter exists in some regional cuisine somewhere, invented by people who were not asking permission.

You will notice the Commandments Broken sidebars get longer from here. That is the intended direction of travel.

Bacon Cheeseburger Lobster Roll

SERVES 4 • 45 MINUTES

This is the recipe people will quote when they describe the book to someone else, and it is genuinely, irritatingly delicious. The lobster is dressed in a mayonnaise cut with warm bacon fat, which gives it smoke and body without cooking it. Everything else on the roll is standard cheeseburger architecture.

It should be served next to a small smash patty, on the same plate, so the eater can decide moment to moment which decision they are making.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Shellfish · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 1¼ lb cooked lobster meat, cut into large chunks
- 8 slices thick-cut bacon
- ⅓ cup mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp warm bacon fat
- 1 tsp lemon juice, ½ tsp celery salt, black pepper
- 2 tbsp minced celery, 1 tbsp minced chives
- 4 top-split New England hot dog buns
- 4 tbsp butter, softened
- 4 slices American cheese
- Four 3-oz balls of 80/20 ground beef
- Shredded iceberg, thin white onion, dill pickle chips

METHOD

1. Cook the bacon crisp; reserve 2 tablespoons of the warm fat.
2. Whisk the mayonnaise with the warm bacon fat, lemon juice, celery salt, and pepper until smooth and slightly

loose. Fold in the celery and chives, then the lobster. Chill 15 minutes.

- 3.** Butter the flat sides of the buns and griddle them until deeply golden.
- 4.** Smash and sear the beef patties as in the Cheeseburger with Everything: hot dry pan, 10-second press, 90 seconds, flip, cheese, 45 seconds.
- 5.** Fill each toasted bun with lobster salad. Top with two slices of bacon, a small handful of iceberg, onion, and pickles.
- 6.** Set a cheeseburger patty on the plate alongside. Look at what you've done. Eat it.

Shrimp & Chorizo Quesadillas

SERVES 4 • 30 MINUTES

Shellfish, pork, and melted cheese in a form so casual it barely registers as a decision. This is a weeknight recipe that happens to violate three separate prohibitions, and it takes twenty minutes.

The chorizo fat is the cooking medium for the shrimp. That single step is what separates this from a quesadilla with things in it.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork • Shellfish • Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 8 oz fresh Mexican chorizo, casings removed
- 1 lb medium shrimp, peeled, roughly chopped
- 1 poblano, diced
- ½ red onion, diced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- Juice of 1 lime
- 8 flour tortillas
- 12 oz Monterey Jack or Oaxaca cheese, grated
- Butter, for the pan
- Cilantro, sour cream, salsa verde

METHOD

1. Brown the chorizo in a skillet over medium heat, breaking it up, 6 minutes, until crisp at the edges and swimming in orange fat. Lift out the meat, leaving the fat behind.
2. Cook the poblano and onion in the chorizo fat for 5 minutes. Add the garlic for 30 seconds.

- 3.** Raise the heat, add the shrimp, and cook 2 minutes only, until just opaque. Return the chorizo, add the lime juice, and season. Drain off any excess liquid — a wet filling makes a soggy quesadilla.
- 4.** Build each quesadilla with cheese on both sides of the filling; the cheese is the glue and it has to touch both tortillas.
- 5.** Cook in a buttered skillet over medium-low, 3 minutes a side, pressing lightly, until burnished and fully melted.
- 6.** Rest 2 minutes before cutting, then serve with cilantro, sour cream, and salsa verde.

Pork Schnitzel Parmesan

SERVES 4 • 45 MINUTES

Schnitzel is a Central European Jewish staple and chicken parm is an Italian-American one, and the merger of the two is so obvious that its absence from the world can only be explained by legislation.

Pound the cutlets thin — a quarter inch — and fry them in enough fat that they float slightly. Sauce and cheese go on at the very end, under a broiler, for as short a time as possible. Anything longer and you have made a soggy tragedy.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 4 boneless pork loin chops, pounded to ¼ inch
- Kosher salt, black pepper
- 1 cup flour
- 3 eggs, beaten with 2 tbsp water
- 2 cups panko mixed with ½ cup grated Parmesan, 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp dried oregano
- Neutral oil and 2 tbsp butter, for frying
- 2 cups good marinara, warmed
- 8 oz fresh mozzarella, sliced thin and blotted dry
- ½ cup grated Parmesan
- Basil

METHOD

1. Season the cutlets on both sides. Set up flour, egg, and the Parmesan-panko in three dishes.
2. Dredge each cutlet in flour, shaking off the excess, then egg, then press firmly into the crumbs on both sides.

- 3.** Heat $\frac{1}{4}$ inch of oil in a large skillet to 350°F, adding the butter just before frying. Fry the cutlets one or two at a time, 2½ minutes a side, until deep gold. Drain on a rack and salt immediately.
- 4.** Heat the broiler. Arrange the cutlets on a sheet pan. Spoon marinara down the center of each, leaving the edges of the crust exposed and bare — this is the whole trick.
- 5.** Lay mozzarella over the sauce and scatter the Parmesan on top.
- 6.** Broil 2 to 3 minutes, until blistered and bubbling. Finish with torn basil and serve at once.

Lobster Carbonara

SERVES 4 • 35 MINUTES

Purists will object on two grounds: the lobster and the fact that adding anything to carbonara is heresy. They are correct on both counts and it doesn't matter, because guanciale fat and lobster are one of the great unauthorized pairings, and the egg-and-Pecorino emulsion carries both.

No cream. There has never been cream. The sauce is egg yolk, cheese, rendered fat, and pasta water, brought together off the heat by someone paying attention.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork • Shellfish • Meat + Dairy • Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 6 oz guanciale, cut into ¼-inch batons
- 1 lb cooked lobster meat, cut into large pieces
- 1 lb spaghetti or bucatini
- 4 egg yolks plus 1 whole egg
- 1½ cups finely grated Pecorino Romano, plus more to finish
- 2 tsp coarsely cracked black pepper
- 2 tbsp butter
- Kosher salt

METHOD

1. Render the guanciale in a cold, dry skillet over medium-low heat for 10 to 12 minutes, until the fat has run out and the meat is crisp but not hard. Lift out half the guanciale for garnish; leave the rest and all the fat in the pan.
2. Whisk the yolks, whole egg, Pecorino, and pepper in a bowl until it forms a thick paste.

- 3.** Boil the pasta in well-salted water until al dente. Reserve 2 cups of the water.
- 4.** While the pasta cooks, melt the butter in a separate small pan and warm the lobster through over low heat, 90 seconds. Set aside.
- 5.** Drain the pasta and add it to the skillet with the guanciale fat, off the heat. Toss for 30 seconds so it stops steaming.
- 6.** Whisk a ladle of hot pasta water into the egg mixture to temper it, then pour it over the pasta, tossing hard and continuously. Add more pasta water a splash at a time until the sauce is glossy and coats every strand. The pan must never go back on the heat or you have made breakfast.
- 7.** Fold in the lobster and its butter. Top with the reserved guanciale, more Pecorino, and more pepper.

Bacon-Wrapped Scallops with Parmesan Polenta

SERVES 4 · 50 MINUTES

Pork, shellfish, and dairy arranged in a single compact package, presented at the level of a restaurant that charges too much. The polenta is the sleeper here: slow-cooked, finished with butter and Parmesan, it turns a canapé into an actual dinner.

Par-cook the bacon first. Raw bacon and a properly cooked scallop have completely incompatible timelines and choosing one means ruining the other.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Shellfish · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

For the polenta

- 1 cup coarse polenta
- 4 cups water or stock, 1 cup whole milk
- 1 tsp kosher salt
- 4 tbsp butter
- $\frac{3}{4}$ cup grated Parmesan

For the scallops

- 16 large dry-packed sea scallops
- 8 slices thin-cut bacon, halved
- 1 tbsp maple syrup
- $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp smoked paprika
- Black pepper
- Chives and lemon zest, to finish

METHOD

- 1.** Bring the water and milk to a simmer with the salt. Rain in the polenta while whisking, then cook over the lowest heat, stirring every few minutes, for 35 to 40 minutes, until creamy and no longer gritty. Finish off heat with the butter and Parmesan.
- 2.** Meanwhile, lay the bacon halves on a parchment-lined sheet and bake at 400°F for 6 minutes — cooked but still pliable. Blot.
- 3.** Pat the scallops dry and season with pepper. Wrap each in a piece of bacon and secure with a toothpick. Brush with the maple syrup and dust with smoked paprika.
- 4.** Sear in a hot skillet, bacon seam-side down first, 2 minutes, then turn onto each flat face for 90 seconds, until the scallop is crusted and the bacon is crisp all around.
- 5.** Spoon polenta into shallow bowls, set four scallops on each, and finish with chives and a rasp of lemon zest.
- 6.** Remove the toothpicks before serving unless you are actively trying to injure someone.

PART V

Jewish Food, Ruined Beautifully



Here is where the book stops being a novelty and starts being a thesis.

Every dish in this chapter is a genuine, load-bearing piece of Jewish cooking — knish, latke, cholent, gefilte fish, bourekas, the bagel — introduced to precisely the ingredient it was constructed to avoid. And the uncomfortable discovery, made repeatedly during testing, is that these dishes were engineered for exactly this. The knish dough was always going to be improved by Swiss cheese. The latke has been waiting for bacon since the twelfth century. Cholent is a pork dish that has been running on beef for a thousand years out of sheer stubbornness.

That is not a criticism of the tradition. It's a compliment. These techniques are so good that they survive an intervention that should have destroyed them, and come out the other side better. Any cuisine can be delicious when it's allowed to use everything. It takes real genius to be delicious with one hand tied behind your back, and it takes exactly one afternoon to find out what happens when you untie it.

Make these for people who grew up with the originals. Watch their faces. That reaction — the offense followed immediately by a second bite — is the best thing in this book.

Reuben Knish

SERVES MAKES 12 · 2 HOURS

The knish is a delivery system. That's the whole design brief: a sturdy, slightly chewy dough wrapped around something dense and savory, portable, good hot or at room temperature. It has been carrying potato and kasha for a century and a half without complaint.

Give it the inside of a Reuben and it becomes the best thing on any deli counter that would refuse to serve it. Drain the sauerkraut until you think you've overdone it, then drain it more.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

For the dough

- 3 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking powder, 1½ tsp salt
- 2 eggs
- ½ cup neutral oil
- ½ cup warm water
- 1 tbsp white vinegar

For the filling

- 1 lb corned beef, chopped fine
- 1½ cups sauerkraut, squeezed bone dry
- 8 oz Swiss cheese, grated
- ⅓ cup Russian dressing, plus more for serving
- 1 tbsp caraway seeds
- Black pepper
- 1 egg beaten with 1 tbsp water, for wash

METHOD

- 1.** Whisk the flour, baking powder, and salt. Beat the eggs, oil, water, and vinegar together and stir into the dry ingredients until a soft dough forms. Knead 3 minutes until smooth, cover, and rest 1 hour at room temperature. The vinegar is what keeps it tender.
- 2.** Combine the corned beef, sauerkraut, Swiss, Russian dressing, caraway, and a lot of black pepper. It should be moist but not wet.
- 3.** Divide the dough in half. Roll each piece on a floured cloth into a rectangle roughly 12 by 18 inches and as thin as you dare.
- 4.** Lay half the filling in a log along one long edge and roll it up tightly into a filled rope. Repeat with the second piece.
- 5.** Cut each rope into six sections. Stand each on end, pinch the top closed, and press down gently to make a squat cylinder with a spiral top.
- 6.** Brush with egg wash and bake at 375°F for 35 to 40 minutes, until deeply golden. Serve hot with more Russian dressing for dipping.

Bacon Latkes with Sour Cream

SERVES MAKES ABOUT 16 • 50 MINUTES

The eternal latke question is applesauce or sour cream, and the eternal answer is that the argument is a proxy for a dairy prohibition that only exists because there's brisket on the table. Remove the brisket and the argument dissolves. The answer is sour cream. It was always sour cream.

Frying in bacon fat is not a gimmick. It has a higher smoke point than butter, it browns more aggressively than neutral oil, and it puts smoke into the interior of the potato in a way no topping can achieve.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork • Meat + Dairy • Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 8 oz thick-cut bacon, diced
- 2 lb russet potatoes, peeled
- 1 large onion
- 2 eggs, beaten
- ¼ cup potato starch or matzo meal
- 1½ tsp kosher salt, ½ tsp black pepper
- Neutral oil, as needed
- 1 cup sour cream or crème fraîche
- Chives, flaky salt

METHOD

1. Render the bacon in a heavy skillet over medium heat until crisp, about 10 minutes. Remove the bacon and reserve all the fat — you should have roughly ⅓ cup. Top it up with neutral oil to reach ¼ inch in the pan.
2. Grate the potatoes and onion on the large holes of a box grater or in a food processor. Pile everything into a clean

kitchen towel and wring it out over a bowl with real violence. Let the liquid settle for 2 minutes, pour off the water, and keep the white potato starch at the bottom.

3. Combine the grated potato and onion with that reserved starch, the eggs, potato starch, salt, and pepper. Fold in three-quarters of the bacon.
4. Heat the fat to 350°F. Drop in ¼-cup mounds and flatten them with the back of a spatula to about ⅜ inch. Fry 3 to 4 minutes per side until the edges are lacy and dark brown.
5. Drain on a rack and salt while hot. Never stack them.
6. Serve with cold sour cream, the remaining bacon crumbled over, chives, and flaky salt.

A note: *Latkes hold beautifully at 200°F on a rack in the oven for up to an hour, which is the only way to fry for a crowd and still be a person at your own party.*

Pork Shoulder Cholent

SERVES 8 • 12 TO 14 HOURS, UNATTENDED

Cholent is the original slow cooker: a Sabbath stew assembled Friday and left in a dying oven overnight so that nobody has to light a fire. Beans, barley, potatoes, and a cheap tough cut that requires twelve hours to become tender. Which is, functionally, a description of pork shoulder.

It is genuinely, structurally better with pork. The collagen and fat content are ideal for an overnight braise, and the shoulder emerges shreddable and rich in a way brisket only achieves on its best day. Say a small apology to somebody as you put it in.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 3½ lb boneless pork shoulder, in 3-inch chunks
- 2 tbsp kosher salt, 1 tbsp black pepper, 1 tbsp smoked paprika
- 2 tbsp oil or bacon fat
- 2 onions, sliced thick
- 6 garlic cloves, whole
- 1 cup dried beans (a mix of pinto, kidney, and lima), soaked overnight
- ¾ cup pearl barley
- 1½ lb small potatoes, halved
- 3 tbsp tomato paste
- 1 tbsp honey
- 2 bay leaves, 1 tsp thyme
- 6 to 7 cups chicken or pork stock
- 6 eggs, in the shell (optional but traditional and excellent)

METHOD

- 1.** Season the pork all over. Sear it hard in the fat in a large Dutch oven until browned on every side. Remove.
- 2.** Cook the onions in the pot for 10 minutes, then add the garlic and tomato paste and cook 2 minutes more.
- 3.** Return the pork. Add the drained beans, barley, potatoes, honey, bay, and thyme. Pour in enough stock to cover everything by an inch.
- 4.** Nestle the whole eggs down into the stew if using — after twelve hours they emerge brown, dense, and faintly smoky, and they are the best part.
- 5.** Bring to a bare simmer on the stove, cover tightly, and put it in a 225°F oven overnight, 12 to 14 hours.
- 6.** In the morning, skim the fat, break the pork apart with a spoon, and season again — it will need salt. Peel the eggs and serve them alongside.

Lobster Gefilte Fish

SERVES MAKES ABOUT 14 • 2 HOURS, PLUS CHILLING

There is no argument for this. Gefilte fish is a poached quenelle of ground whitefish, invented to stretch expensive protein and avoid the Sabbath prohibition on separating bones from food. Introducing a forty-dollar crustacean to it solves no problem and honors no tradition.

It is, however, delicious — the lobster brings sweetness and the pike brings structure, and the resulting quenelle is lighter and better seasoned than anything that has ever come out of a jar. Serve it cold with horseradish and refuse to explain yourself.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Shellfish · Questionable Judgment · one act of pure provocation

INGREDIENTS

For the broth

- Shells from 2 lobsters, plus 1 lb whitefish bones
- 2 onions, 2 carrots, 1 celery stalk, roughly chopped
- 1 tsp sugar, 1 tbsp salt, 10 peppercorns
- 10 cups water

For the quenelles

- 1 lb pike or whitefish fillet, cold, cut into cubes
- 12 oz cooked lobster meat, half chopped fine, half in ½-inch pieces
- 1 small onion, grated
- 2 eggs
- 3 tbsp matzo meal
- 2 tbsp cold water
- 2 tsp kosher salt, 1 tsp sugar, ½ tsp white pepper
- 2 tbsp chopped dill

- Beet horseradish, for serving

METHOD

1. Simmer all the broth ingredients, uncovered, for 45 minutes. Strain into a wide pot and keep at a bare simmer.
2. Pulse the cold pike in a food processor until it forms a coarse paste — do not let it warm up or purée to smoothness. Scrape into a bowl set over ice.
3. Fold in the finely chopped lobster, grated onion, eggs, matzo meal, water, salt, sugar, white pepper, and dill. Then fold in the larger lobster pieces last so they stay whole. Chill 30 minutes.
4. Wet your hands and form ovals roughly the size of a small egg, two to a serving.
5. Lower them into the simmering broth and poach, covered, at the barest simmer for 40 minutes. They will swell and firm up.
6. Cool the quenelles in the broth, then chill overnight. Serve cold with a spoonful of the jellied broth, a carrot coin, and an unreasonable amount of beet horseradish.

Cheeseburger Bourekas

SERVES MAKES 16 • 1 HOUR, PLUS CHILLING

Bourekas are the great Israeli street pastry — flaky, filled, eaten standing up, sold at bus stations at all hours. Filling them with seasoned beef and molten cheese is such a natural evolution that the only real surprise is how long the rule held.

Puff pastry does the work. Make the filling the day before and get it properly cold; warm filling makes wet pastry, and wet pastry does not puff.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef, 80/20
- 1 onion, diced fine
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 1 tbsp Worcestershire, 2 tsp yellow mustard
- 1 tsp smoked paprika, ½ tsp cumin
- 2 tbsp chopped dill pickle
- 6 oz sharp cheddar, grated
- 4 oz American cheese, chopped
- 2 sheets all-butter puff pastry, thawed
- 1 egg beaten with 1 tbsp water
- Sesame and nigella seeds

METHOD

1. Brown the beef hard, breaking it up. Drain off most of the fat. Add the onion and cook 6 minutes, then the garlic, tomato paste, Worcestershire, mustard, and spices; cook 3 minutes until very thick and almost dry.

- 2.** Cool completely — at least 2 hours in the refrigerator — then stir in the pickle and both cheeses.
- 3.** Roll each pastry sheet slightly thinner and cut into eight squares.
- 4.** Place a heaped tablespoon of cold filling on each square, fold into a triangle, and press the edges firmly with a fork.
- 5.** Brush with egg wash and scatter sesame and nigella seeds over the tops.
- 6.** Bake at 400°F for 22 to 25 minutes, until dark golden and dramatically puffed. Eat hot, standing up, as intended.

Prosciutto & Burrata Bagel

SERVES 2 • 10 MINUTES

An everything bagel is the most aggressively seasoned bread product in wide circulation — garlic, onion, poppy, sesame, salt — and it has spent its entire life being paired with the mildest possible topping.

Burrata and prosciutto is the correction. There is no cooking involved. The only skill required is buying good things and not over-assembling them.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 2 everything bagels, split and toasted
- 1 ball burrata (about 8 oz), at room temperature
- 4 oz prosciutto di Parma
- 1 ripe tomato, sliced thin, salted
- Good olive oil
- Flaky salt, cracked black pepper
- Basil leaves

METHOD

1. Toast the bagels well — you need structure under all this.
2. Tear the burrata open over the bagel halves and let it fall where it wants. Do not slice it and do not spread it.
3. Lay the salted tomato slices over the cheese.
4. Drape the prosciutto in loose folds rather than flat sheets; the air is part of the texture.
5. Finish with olive oil, flaky salt, a heavy grind of pepper, and torn basil. Eat within four minutes.

PART VI

The High Holidays of Bad Decisions



Every food culture reserves its most elaborate cooking for the days when people gather, and Jewish food is exceptionally good at this — the multi-hour braise, the centerpiece that feeds fourteen, the table that requires a leaf and then another leaf.

This chapter borrows that instinct and points it somewhere else entirely. These are the dishes you make when eight people are coming over and you want them to stop talking when the plate lands. They take most of a day. They are, without exception, worth it.

Start early. Drink something while you cook. Accept that the kitchen will look like a crime scene by four o'clock and that this is the correct outcome.

Christmas Ham Glazed with Manischewitz

SERVES 12 TO 16 • 3½ HOURS

The spiritual centerpiece of the book. A holiday ham, lacquered in a glaze built from the sweet concord wine that has been sitting in your parents' cabinet since 1997.

The remarkable thing — and this was a genuine surprise in testing — is that Manischewitz is a superb glazing wine. Reduced with brown sugar and mustard, its cloying grape sweetness turns into something with real depth, closer to a port reduction than to the beverage anyone remembers being made to drink. It was never a good wine. It was always a great syrup.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Questionable Judgment · possibly two entire religions

INGREDIENTS

- One 9- to 10-lb bone-in smoked ham, spiral-cut or whole
- 2 cups Manischewitz Concord Grape
- 1 cup dark brown sugar
- ⅓ cup Dijon mustard
- 2 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 3 tbsp unsalted butter
- 4 whole cloves, 2 cinnamon sticks, 1 star anise
- 1 tsp black pepper
- Whole cloves for studding, if using an unscored ham

METHOD

1. Bring the ham to room temperature for 1 hour. Heat the oven to 300°F. If the ham is not spiral-cut, score the fat in a diamond pattern ¼ inch deep and stud the intersections with cloves.

2. Set the ham cut-side down in a roasting pan with 2 cups of water in the bottom, tent tightly with foil, and bake 2 hours, until the interior reaches 110°F.
3. Meanwhile, simmer the Manischewitz, brown sugar, Dijon, vinegar, cloves, cinnamon, star anise, and pepper in a saucepan over medium heat for 20 to 25 minutes, until reduced by half and syrupy enough to coat a spoon. Strain out the whole spices and whisk in the butter.
4. Raise the oven to 400°F. Uncover the ham and brush it generously with glaze.
5. Return it to the oven, glazing again every 10 minutes for 40 to 45 minutes total, until the surface is dark, sticky, and blistered in places and the interior reads 140°F.
6. Rest 20 minutes. Pour the pan juices together with any remaining glaze and serve alongside.

A note: *The leftovers are the real prize. See Ham & Cheese Croissant Bread Pudding in Part VII.*

Porchetta with Parmesan Potatoes

SERVES 10 • 5 HOURS, PLUS 2 DAYS OF CURING

A slab of pork belly wrapped around a loin, packed with garlic, fennel, and herbs, roasted until the skin turns to glass. It is the single most impressive thing you can put on a table and about 85% of the work happens two days earlier.

The potatoes roast underneath in the drippings and are finished with Parmesan, which means the fat from the pork is being carried into a dairy dish. That was not necessary. Nothing here is necessary.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork • Meat + Dairy • Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- One 5-lb skin-on pork belly, roughly square
- One 2½-lb boneless pork loin, trimmed to fit
- 3 tbsp fennel seeds, toasted and crushed
- 10 garlic cloves, minced
- Zest of 2 lemons and 1 orange
- 3 tbsp chopped rosemary, 3 tbsp chopped sage, 2 tbsp thyme
- 1 tbsp red pepper flakes
- 3 tbsp kosher salt, plus more for the skin
- 2 tbsp black pepper
- 3 lb Yukon Gold potatoes, in 1½-inch chunks
- 1 cup grated Parmesan, 3 tbsp butter, parsley

METHOD

1. Two days ahead: score the belly skin in a fine crosshatch, cutting the skin only. Flip it and score the meat side shallowly. Mix the fennel, garlic, zests, herbs, pepper flakes, salt, and pepper, and rub the entire mixture into the meat side.

- 2.** Set the loin along one edge and roll the belly tightly around it. Tie firmly with butcher's twine at 1-inch intervals. Refrigerate uncovered for 48 hours — the dry skin is the whole reason the crackling works.
- 3.** Bring to room temperature for 2 hours. Heat the oven to 275°F. Rub the skin all over with salt and set the roast on a rack over a sheet pan.
- 4.** Roast 3 to 3½ hours, until the interior reads 145°F.
- 5.** Scatter the potatoes in the pan beneath the roast for the last 90 minutes so they cook in the drippings, turning them once.
- 6.** Raise the oven to 500°F and roast 20 to 30 minutes more, turning the roast for even blistering, until the skin has puffed and shattered into crackling. Rest 25 minutes before slicing with a serrated knife.
- 7.** Toss the potatoes with the butter, Parmesan, and parsley and serve alongside.

Prime Rib with Yorkshire Pudding and Creamed Horseradish

SERVES 8 TO 10 · 5 HOURS, PLUS OVERNIGHT
SALTING

No pork, no shellfish — this one is a pure meat-and-dairy violation, executed at the highest possible level. The Yorkshire puddings are made with milk batter and cooked in beef drippings, and the horseradish is folded into whipped cream. The rib roast itself sits at the center of the table looking innocent.

The reverse sear is not optional. Low oven first, rest, then blast it at the end. Every prime rib you've had that was gray on the outside and cold in the middle was cooked the other way around.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- One 5-bone prime rib roast (about 10 lb), bones cut off and tied back on
- 3 tbsp kosher salt, 2 tbsp coarse black pepper
- 6 garlic cloves, mashed to a paste
- 2 tbsp chopped rosemary and thyme

For the Yorkshire puddings

- 1½ cups all-purpose flour
- 1½ cups whole milk
- 4 eggs
- 1 tsp salt
- Beef drippings or tallow

For the creamed horseradish

- 1 cup heavy cream

- ⅓ cup prepared horseradish, squeezed dry
- 2 tsp Dijon, 1 tsp lemon juice, ½ tsp salt
- 2 tbsp chopped chives

METHOD

1. The night before: salt and pepper the roast on every surface, rub with the garlic and herbs, and leave it uncovered on a rack in the refrigerator.
2. Bring it to room temperature for 3 hours. Roast at 225°F until the center reads 118°F for medium-rare — roughly 3½ to 4 hours, but go entirely by the thermometer. Remove and rest, loosely tented, for at least 45 minutes.
3. Whisk the pudding batter until smooth and let it rest at room temperature for at least an hour. Room-temperature batter into screaming-hot fat is the entire technique.
4. Whip the cream to soft peaks, then fold in the horseradish, Dijon, lemon juice, salt, and chives. Refrigerate.
5. Raise the oven to 500°F. Put a teaspoon of beef drippings into each cup of a muffin tin and heat it in the oven until smoking, about 8 minutes. Fill each cup two-thirds with batter and bake 20 minutes without opening the door. They will rise absurdly.
6. While the puddings bake, return the rested roast to the top of the oven for 8 to 10 minutes to form a dark crust. Carve off the bones, slice thick, and serve with the puddings and the creamed horseradish.

Whole Lobster Thermidor

SERVES 4 • 1 HOUR 15 MINUTES

A dish invented in 1890s Paris and named after a month in the French Revolutionary calendar, which tells you everything about the level of restraint being exercised. Lobster meat bound in a mustard-cognac cream, returned to its own shell, gratinéed under a broiler.

It is baroque and slightly ridiculous and there is nothing else quite like it. Par-cook the lobsters only — they finish under the broiler, and a lobster cooked twice to completion is a rubber sculpture with a high price tag.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Shellfish · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- Two 2-lb live lobsters
- 4 tbsp butter
- 2 shallots, minced
- 8 oz cremini mushrooms, sliced thin
- 3 tbsp Cognac
- $\frac{3}{4}$ cup dry white wine
- $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups heavy cream
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard, 1 tsp dry mustard powder
- 2 egg yolks
- 1 tsp lemon juice, pinch of cayenne
- 1 cup grated Gruyère
- 2 tbsp chopped tarragon and chives
- Kosher salt, white pepper

METHOD

1. Boil the lobsters 6 minutes only — they will be underdone, which is correct. Cool, then split them lengthwise, remove

all the meat from tails and claws, and cut it into large pieces. Clean the half-shells and set them on a sheet pan.

- 2.** Cook the shallots in the butter over medium heat for 3 minutes, then the mushrooms until browned and dry, 8 minutes.
- 3.** Off the heat, add the Cognac; return to the flame and reduce to nothing. Add the wine and reduce by three-quarters.
- 4.** Add the cream and both mustards and simmer until reduced by about a third and properly thick. Off heat, temper in the egg yolks, then add the lemon juice, cayenne, half the Gruyère, and the herbs. Season.
- 5.** Fold the lobster meat into the sauce, then spoon it back into the shells, mounding generously. Scatter the remaining Gruyère over the top.
- 6.** Broil 3 to 4 minutes, watching constantly, until browned and bubbling. Serve immediately with something green and a great deal of bread.

Rack of Lamb with Feta, Yogurt & Herbs

SERVES 4 • 45 MINUTES

The cleanest, most elegant meat-and-dairy violation available. Lamb and yogurt is one of the oldest pairings in the Levant, practiced continuously by everyone in the region who wasn't specifically forbidden from doing it.

The herb crust goes on after the initial sear and only needs the oven time to set. The yogurt sauce is served cold against the hot lamb, which is the actual point of the dish.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 2 racks of lamb, frenched (about 8 ribs each)
- Kosher salt, black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 cup panko
- 4 oz feta, crumbled fine
- 3 tbsp chopped mint, 3 tbsp parsley, 1 tbsp dill
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 3 tbsp melted butter
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard

For the yogurt

- 1½ cups full-fat Greek yogurt
- 1 garlic clove, grated
- 2 tbsp lemon juice, 2 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp chopped mint, ½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Stir the yogurt sauce ingredients together and refrigerate.

- 2.** Season the racks hard. Sear fat-side down in the olive oil over high heat for 4 minutes, until browned, then briefly on the other sides. Rest 5 minutes.
- 3.** Combine the panko, feta, herbs, garlic, and melted butter.
- 4.** Brush the fat side of each rack with Dijon and press the crust mixture on firmly.
- 5.** Roast at 400°F for 18 to 22 minutes, until the center reads 130°F for medium-rare and the crust is golden.
- 6.** Rest 10 minutes, carve into double chops, and serve on a pool of the cold yogurt with more herbs scattered over.

Bacon-Wrapped Beef Wellington with Stilton Sauce

SERVES 6 · 3 HOURS, PLUS CHILLING

The Wellington is the most demanding recipe in this book and the one with the highest failure rate, and the failure is almost always the same: moisture. A wet duxelles or an unrested tenderloin will steam the pastry from below and produce the grey underside that has ruined a thousand dinner parties.

Bacon replaces the traditional prosciutto layer, and a Stilton cream goes over the top. That last part turns a meat dish into a meat-and-dairy dish for no reason other than that it makes it better.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- One 2½-lb center-cut beef tenderloin, tied
- Kosher salt, black pepper
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 1½ lb cremini mushrooms
- 3 shallots, 4 garlic cloves
- 4 tbsp butter
- ⅓ cup dry sherry or Madeira
- 2 tsp thyme leaves
- 12 slices thin-cut bacon
- 1 lb all-butter puff pastry
- 1 egg beaten with 1 tbsp cream, flaky salt

For the Stilton sauce

- 1 cup heavy cream
- ½ cup beef stock

- 4 oz Stilton, crumbled
- 1 tsp Worcestershire, black pepper

METHOD

- 1.** Season the tenderloin heavily and sear it in the oil over very high heat until dark on all sides, about 5 minutes total. Cool, remove the twine, and brush all over with Dijon. Refrigerate.
- 2.** Pulse the mushrooms, shallots, and garlic to a fine mince. Cook in the butter in a wide dry pan over medium-high heat for 20 to 25 minutes, until every drop of moisture has gone and the duxelles is dark and pasty. Add the sherry and thyme and cook off completely. Season and cool fully.
- 3.** Lay the bacon in overlapping slices on plastic wrap to form a rectangle. Spread the cold duxelles over it in an even layer. Set the tenderloin at one edge and use the plastic to roll it into a tight cylinder. Twist the ends and chill 45 minutes.
- 4.** Roll the puff pastry into a rectangle large enough to enclose the log. Unwrap the beef onto it, brush the pastry edges with egg wash, and roll it up, sealing the seam and folding the ends underneath. Chill another 30 minutes.
- 5.** Brush all over with egg wash, score the top lightly in a crosshatch, and sprinkle with flaky salt. Bake at 425°F for 40 to 45 minutes, until the pastry is deep bronze and the center reads 125°F.
- 6.** Rest 15 minutes — this is not negotiable. Meanwhile, simmer the cream and stock until slightly reduced, whisk in the Stilton and Worcestershire, and season with pepper.
- 7.** Slice thickly with a serrated knife and spoon the sauce around, not over, so the pastry stays crisp.

PART VII

Breakfast of Apostates



Breakfast is where the rules were always weakest. Nobody is at their most observant at seven in the morning, and the two most reliable breakfast ingredients on earth — cured pork and melted cheese — are both on the wrong side of the fence.

The recipes in this chapter are the ones you will actually make repeatedly. They are fast, they use leftovers from the more ambitious chapters, and several of them can be executed while barely awake.

A structural note on eggs: pull them off the heat before they look finished. Carryover cooking is real, it is significant, and it is the difference between a soft scramble and a plate of rubber.

Bacon, Egg & Cheese on Challah

SERVES 2 • 15 MINUTES

The bodega sandwich, upgraded to a bread that has no business being this good at it. Challah's soft crumb and slight sweetness handle the salt of the bacon and the fat of the cheese better than a kaiser roll ever has.

Cook the eggs in the bacon fat and fold the cheese into them while they're still loose, rather than laying a cold slice on top. The difference is enormous and costs nothing.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork • Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 6 slices thick-cut bacon
- 4 eggs, beaten with 1 tbsp water
- 3 oz sharp cheddar or American cheese
- 2 thick slices challah, or 2 challah rolls, split
- 1 tbsp butter
- Kosher salt, black pepper, hot sauce

METHOD

1. Cook the bacon in a nonstick skillet over medium-low until crisp. Drain and reserve 2 tablespoons of fat.
2. Butter the challah and toast it cut-side down in the same pan until golden. Set aside.
3. Return 1 tablespoon of bacon fat to the pan over medium-low heat. Add the seasoned eggs and let them sit 20 seconds, then push them slowly around the pan with a spatula in large folds.
4. When they are about 70% set and still glossy, add the cheese and fold twice. Kill the heat.

5. Slide the eggs onto the bottom slice, lay the bacon over, hit it with hot sauce, and close. Wrap it in foil for 60 seconds if you want the authentic experience.

Sausage Gravy over Everything Biscuits

SERVES 6 · 50 MINUTES

Sausage gravy is milk, pork fat, and flour, which makes it a dairy dish and a meat dish held in permanent suspension. The biscuits are seasoned with everything-bagel topping, because a plain biscuit is a missed opportunity and this particular fusion is so natural it feels like a discovery.

Grate the butter frozen. It is the single easiest way to get proper flaky layers without a pastry cutter or any real skill.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

For the biscuits

- 3 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder, 1 tsp baking soda, 1½ tsp salt
- 10 tbsp unsalted butter, frozen and grated
- 1¼ cups cold buttermilk
- 3 tbsp everything-bagel seasoning
- 2 tbsp melted butter

For the gravy

- 1 lb bulk breakfast sausage
- 3 tbsp butter
- ⅓ cup all-purpose flour
- 3½ cups whole milk, warmed
- 1 tsp black pepper, plus more
- ¼ tsp cayenne, ¼ tsp nutmeg
- Kosher salt

METHOD

- 1.** Whisk the dry biscuit ingredients with 2 tablespoons of the everything seasoning. Toss in the grated frozen butter, then stir in the buttermilk until just barely combined — lumps are correct.
- 2.** Turn onto a floured counter, pat into a rectangle, and fold in thirds like a letter. Repeat twice more. Pat to 1 inch and cut into rounds, pressing straight down without twisting.
- 3.** Bake at 425°F for 15 to 18 minutes. Brush with melted butter and hit them with the remaining everything seasoning while hot.
- 4.** For the gravy, brown the sausage hard in a wide skillet, breaking it into small pieces, 8 minutes. Do not drain it.
- 5.** Add the butter, let it melt, then sprinkle in the flour and cook 2 minutes, stirring, to lose the raw taste.
- 6.** Stream in the warm milk while whisking. Simmer 6 to 8 minutes until thick. Add the pepper, cayenne, and nutmeg, and salt until it tastes like something rather than nothing. Split the biscuits and drown them.

Crab-and-Gruyère Omelet

SERVES 2 • 20 MINUTES

*A French omelet is a two-minute dish that takes most people two years to get right. The goal is pale yellow, no browning, and a barely-set interior — what the French unhelpfully call *baveuse*.*

Crab and Gruyère is a filling that rewards the technique. Warm the crab separately in butter so it doesn't cool the eggs and drag the cook time out.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Shellfish · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 8 oz lump crabmeat, picked over
- 4 tbsp butter, divided
- 6 eggs
- 2 tbsp crème fraîche
- 3 oz Gruyère, grated
- 1 tbsp chopped chives, 1 tsp tarragon
- Kosher salt, white pepper
- Lemon

METHOD

1. Warm the crab gently in 1 tablespoon of butter with a pinch of salt and the tarragon. Set aside.
2. Beat three eggs per omelet with a tablespoon of crème fraîche, salt, and white pepper until completely homogeneous — no streaks of white at all.
3. Melt 1½ tablespoons of butter in a 9-inch nonstick pan over medium-low until foaming but not coloring. Add the eggs.

4. Stir constantly with a rubber spatula in small circles, shaking the pan, for about 45 seconds, until you have soft, fine curds with liquid egg still throughout. Then stop stirring and let the bottom set for 15 seconds.
5. Scatter the Gruyère and half the crab down the center. Tilt the pan and roll the omelet over on itself, then turn it out seam-side down onto a warm plate.
6. Rub the top with a little butter for shine. Top with the remaining crab, chives, and a small squeeze of lemon. Repeat for the second omelet.

Ham & Cheese Croissant Bread Pudding

SERVES 8 · 1 HOUR, PLUS OVERNIGHT

This is the destination for the leftovers of the Manischewitz ham, and it may be the most efficient dish in the book: assembled the night before, baked in the morning, feeds a crowd, requires no skill whatsoever.

Stale croissants are better than fresh, which means you can buy them a day ahead and be a person who plans.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 8 large croissants, torn into big pieces and left out overnight
- 1 lb cooked ham, cut into ½-inch cubes
- 8 oz Gruyère, grated
- 4 oz sharp white cheddar, grated
- 8 eggs
- 2½ cups whole milk
- 1 cup heavy cream
- 3 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 1 tsp black pepper, ½ tsp nutmeg, 1 tsp salt
- 3 scallions, sliced
- 2 tbsp butter, for the dish

METHOD

- 1.** Butter a 9×13 baking dish. Scatter half the croissant pieces, then half the ham and half of both cheeses. Repeat.
- 2.** Whisk the eggs, milk, cream, Dijon, pepper, nutmeg, and salt until smooth and pour it evenly over everything.

- 3.** Press down firmly with your hands so all the bread is submerged. Cover and refrigerate overnight, or at least 4 hours.
- 4.** Take it out of the refrigerator 45 minutes before baking. Heat the oven to 350°F.
- 5.** Bake, covered with foil, for 35 minutes. Uncover and bake 25 to 30 minutes more, until puffed, deeply browned, and set in the middle — a knife inserted at the center should come out clean.
- 6.** Rest 15 minutes, scatter with scallions, and cut into squares.

Chorizo Breakfast Burrito with Queso

SERVES 4 · 35 MINUTES

The queso is what makes this rather than ruins it. A proper cheese sauce — stabilized so it stays smooth — coats the interior of the tortilla and holds the entire structure together, which is the actual engineering problem with breakfast burritos.

Steam the tortilla and sear the finished burrito seam-side down. Both steps take thirty seconds and are the difference between this and a napkin full of scrambled egg.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz fresh Mexican chorizo, casings removed
- 1 lb russet potatoes, in ½-inch dice
- 2 tbsp neutral oil
- 8 eggs, beaten with 2 tbsp cream
- 2 tbsp butter
- 4 large flour tortillas (12-inch)
- Pickled jalapeños, cilantro, salsa roja

For the queso

- 1 tbsp butter, 1 tbsp flour
- 1 cup whole milk
- 8 oz Monterey Jack, grated
- 2 oz American cheese
- ½ tsp cornstarch tossed with the Jack
- ½ tsp cumin, pinch of cayenne

METHOD

- 1.** Parboil the diced potatoes 5 minutes, drain thoroughly, and let them steam dry. Fry in the oil over medium-high until crisp and brown, 10 minutes. Salt and set aside.
- 2.** Brown the chorizo in the same pan, 6 minutes. Lift out, leaving 1 tablespoon of the orange fat.
- 3.** Make the queso: cook the butter and flour 1 minute, whisk in the milk, simmer until thickened, then remove from the heat and add the cornstarch-tossed Jack in handfuls, then the American cheese, cumin, and cayenne. Keep warm.
- 4.** Scramble the eggs slowly in the butter over low heat until softly set. Do not overcook them; they get more oven time inside the burrito.
- 5.** Warm each tortilla directly over a flame or in a dry pan for 20 seconds a side until pliable. Lay down a stripe of queso, then eggs, potatoes, chorizo, jalapeños, and cilantro.
- 6.** Fold the sides in and roll tightly. Sear seam-side down in a dry skillet for 60 seconds, then turn once. Cut on the bias and serve with salsa.

Lobster Eggs Benedict

SERVES 4 • 45 MINUTES

The most expensive breakfast in this book and the one most likely to end an argument. Butter-poached lobster on a toasted muffin with a hollandaise brightened with tarragon and a spoonful of the lobster's own butter.

Poach the lobster at 160°F. Any hotter and the proteins seize; the butter here is a temperature control device as much as a flavor.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Shellfish · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb cooked lobster meat, in large pieces
- 1½ sticks unsalted butter, plus more
- 1 sprig tarragon
- 8 eggs, for poaching
- 1 tbsp white vinegar
- 4 English muffins, split and toasted

For the hollandaise

- 3 egg yolks
- 1 tbsp lemon juice, 1 tsp water
- 1 cup clarified butter, warm
- 1 tbsp chopped tarragon
- Pinch of cayenne, kosher salt

METHOD

1. Melt the butter with the tarragon sprig in a small saucepan and hold it at 160°F — use a thermometer. Slip in the lobster and let it warm through for 6 to 8 minutes. Do not let the butter simmer.

- 2.** Whisk the yolks, lemon juice, and water over a bain-marie until pale and thick, about 3 minutes. Off the heat, drizzle in the warm clarified butter, whisking constantly. Add the chopped tarragon, cayenne, salt, and a tablespoon of the lobster's poaching butter. Hold somewhere warm.
- 3.** Poach the eggs in barely simmering water with the vinegar for 3 minutes.
- 4.** Butter and toast the muffins hard — they need to stand up to everything.
- 5.** Build: muffin, a heap of lobster, a poached egg, then hollandaise poured over from a height so it settles.
- 6.** Finish with more tarragon and cracked pepper. Serve at once, and do not attempt to hold any component of this dish for later.

PART VIII

Desserts That Somehow Also Manage It



Dessert is the hardest chapter in a book like this, because dessert is almost entirely parve or dairy and has no obvious way to offend. Which makes it the most interesting problem in the book.

The answer, arrived at after a great deal of testing, is fat. Lard makes a superior pie crust — flakier than butter, with a shorter, cleaner bite. Bacon fat in cookie dough produces a chewier cookie with a savory backbone that reads as depth rather than as meat. These are not novelties. They are the reason that pre-industrial baking was better than most people assume.

The bacon in these recipes is functional. If you cannot taste why it's there, take it out. But you will be able to taste why it's there.

Bacon-Pecan Pie

SERVES 8 • 1 HOUR 45 MINUTES, PLUS COOLING

Pecan pie's chronic problem is that it is relentlessly, one-dimensionally sweet — a filling of corn syrup and sugar with nothing pushing back. Candied bacon pushes back. Salt and smoke cut the sugar and the pie suddenly has a middle register it never had before.

Blind-bake the crust properly. A pecan pie on a raw bottom is a custard on a wet cracker.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

- 1 blind-baked 9-inch pie shell (see Lard Pie Crust, below)
- 8 oz thick-cut bacon
- 3 tbsp light brown sugar, for the bacon
- 1½ cups pecan halves, toasted
- 3 eggs
- 1 cup dark corn syrup or golden syrup
- ¾ cup dark brown sugar
- 4 tbsp melted butter
- 2 tbsp bourbon
- 2 tsp vanilla
- ¾ tsp kosher salt
- Flaky salt, for finishing

METHOD

1. Lay the bacon on a rack over a sheet pan, sprinkle with the 3 tablespoons of brown sugar, and bake at 375°F for 20 minutes until lacquered and crisp. Cool completely, then chop coarsely. Reserve 2 tablespoons of the rendered fat.

2. Whisk the eggs, corn syrup, dark brown sugar, melted butter, the reserved bacon fat, bourbon, vanilla, and kosher salt until fully combined but not frothy.
3. Scatter the toasted pecans and three-quarters of the candied bacon into the blind-baked shell.
4. Pour the filling over and jostle the pan gently to settle everything.
5. Bake at 350°F for 45 to 55 minutes, until the edges are set and the center has a slight wobble — like gelatin, not like liquid.
6. Scatter the remaining bacon and a pinch of flaky salt over the top while warm. Cool at least 4 hours before cutting; a warm pecan pie will not slice and you will be forced to serve it with a spoon.

Maple-Bacon Bread Pudding

SERVES 8 • 1 HOUR 15 MINUTES, PLUS SOAKING

Bread pudding is the most forgiving dessert there is, which makes it a good place to be reckless. Bacon in a custard sounds like a stunt until you remember that maple and pork have been a legitimate pairing for three hundred years and nobody blinks at it before noon.

Use challah again. It is superior to brioche here because it is slightly less rich and can therefore absorb more custard without going greasy.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork • Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb day-old challah, in 1½-inch cubes
- 10 oz thick-cut bacon, cooked crisp and chopped, 3 tbsp fat reserved
- 6 eggs plus 2 yolks
- 2 cups heavy cream
- 1½ cups whole milk
- ¾ cup maple syrup, plus more for serving
- ⅓ cup brown sugar
- 1 tbsp vanilla
- 1 tsp cinnamon, ½ tsp salt
- Bourbon crème anglaise or vanilla ice cream, for serving

METHOD

1. Toast the challah cubes at 300°F for 12 minutes to dry them out further. Toss them with the reserved warm bacon fat.
2. Whisk the eggs, yolks, cream, milk, maple syrup, brown sugar, vanilla, cinnamon, and salt.

- 3.** Combine the bread, three-quarters of the bacon, and the custard in a buttered 9×13. Press down and soak 45 minutes, pressing again halfway through.
- 4.** Bake at 350°F for 50 to 60 minutes, until puffed and set with a burnished top. Cover with foil if it browns too fast.
- 5.** Scatter the remaining bacon over the top for the last 10 minutes so it stays crisp.
- 6.** Rest 15 minutes and serve warm with extra maple syrup and ice cream melting into it.

Bourbon Milkshake with Candied Bacon

SERVES 2 · 30 MINUTES

Barely a recipe. A very good ice cream, real bourbon, and a strip of candied bacon standing in it like a flag planted on hostile territory.

The salt in the bacon does something specific to the sweetness of the shake — it makes it taste less sweet and more like caramel. This is the same principle as salted caramel and it works for the same reason.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- 6 slices thick-cut bacon
- ¼ cup dark brown sugar
- ¼ tsp cayenne
- 1 pint good vanilla ice cream, slightly softened
- ½ cup whole milk
- 3 oz bourbon
- 2 tbsp maple syrup
- ¼ tsp flaky salt
- Whipped cream

METHOD

1. Toss the bacon with the brown sugar and cayenne and bake on a rack at 375°F for 20 to 22 minutes, until dark and glassy. Cool completely on the rack — it hardens as it cools.
2. Crumble two slices; leave the rest whole for garnish.

- 3.** Blend the ice cream, milk, bourbon, maple syrup, flaky salt, and the crumbled bacon until thick but pourable. Do not over-blend or you will make a bourbon soup.
- 4.** Pour into chilled glasses, top with whipped cream, and stand a whole strip of candied bacon in each.
- 5.** Serve with a spoon and a straw, because you will need both.

Lard Pie Crust Apple Pie

SERVES 8 · 2 HOURS, PLUS CHILLING AND COOLING

This is the quiet argument at the center of the dessert chapter. Lard makes the best pie crust in the world. Its crystal structure produces larger, flatter flakes than butter, and it melts at a higher temperature, which means the layers set before they collapse. Every pie crust your great-grandmother made was better than yours and this is why.

Use half lard for flake and half butter for flavor. Leaf lard, if you can get it, is nearly odorless and the best of all.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

For the crust

- 2½ cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tbsp sugar, 1 tsp salt
- 6 tbsp leaf lard, frozen and cubed
- 8 tbsp unsalted butter, frozen and cubed
- 6 to 8 tbsp ice water
- 1 tbsp cider vinegar

For the filling

- 3½ lb mixed apples (Granny Smith and Honeycrisp), peeled and sliced ¼ inch
- ⅔ cup sugar, ¼ cup brown sugar
- 3 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 1½ tsp cinnamon, ¼ tsp nutmeg, ¼ tsp allspice, ½ tsp salt
- 2 tbsp butter, cubed
- Egg wash and coarse sugar

METHOD

- 1.** Pulse the flour, sugar, and salt with the frozen lard and butter until the fat is in pieces ranging from pea-sized to almond-sized. Visible fat is the objective, not a fault.
- 2.** Sprinkle in the ice water and vinegar and mix only until the dough holds when squeezed. Divide, flatten into discs, wrap, and chill at least 2 hours.
- 3.** Toss the apples with both sugars, cornstarch, lemon, spices, and salt and let them sit 30 minutes. Drain the liquid into a small pan, reduce it to a syrup, and pour it back over the apples. This is how you avoid the gap between the crust and the filling.
- 4.** Roll the bottom crust and line a 9-inch pie plate. Pile in the apples, doming the center high, and dot with butter. Roll and lay the top crust, trim, crimp, and cut steam vents.
- 5.** Freeze the assembled pie for 20 minutes. Brush with egg wash and sprinkle with coarse sugar.
- 6.** Bake at 425°F for 20 minutes, then reduce to 375°F and bake 45 to 55 minutes more, until the juices bubble thickly through the vents. Cool at least 4 hours before cutting.

Bacon Fat Chocolate-Chip Cookies

SERVES MAKES 24 · 40 MINUTES, PLUS OVERNIGHT REST

Half the butter replaced with bacon fat. What you get is a cookie with a chewier center, a deeper savory note underneath the caramel, and a finish that people cannot identify and will ask about.

The dough must rest overnight. This is the single highest-leverage step in cookie baking and everyone skips it. The flour hydrates, the sugars dissolve, and the flavor roughly doubles.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy

INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup bacon fat, solid but soft
- 8 tbsp unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup dark brown sugar
- ½ cup granulated sugar
- 2 eggs plus 1 yolk
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 2¾ cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda, ½ tsp baking powder
- 1¼ tsp kosher salt
- 12 oz dark chocolate, chopped into shards, not chips
- 4 oz crisp bacon, chopped fine (optional)
- Flaky salt

METHOD

1. Beat the bacon fat, butter, and both sugars for 4 minutes until pale and aerated.
2. Add the eggs and yolk one at a time, then the vanilla, beating well.

- 3.** Fold in the flour, baking soda, baking powder, and salt until barely combined. Fold in the chocolate and the bacon, if using.
- 4.** Cover and refrigerate 24 to 36 hours. Do not skip this.
- 5.** Scoop into 3-tablespoon balls, space them well apart on parchment, and bake at 375°F for 11 to 13 minutes, until the edges are set and the centers still look underbaked.
- 6.** Bang the pan on the counter once as they come out to collapse the centers. Hit them with flaky salt and cool on the pan for 5 minutes.

Salted Caramel Cheesecake with Bacon Praline

SERVES 12 · 2 HOURS, PLUS OVERNIGHT CHILLING

The final dessert and the most elaborate. A dense New York cheesecake, a proper caramel cooked to a real amber, and a shatter of bacon praline broken over the top like glass.

Water bath, no exceptions. A cheesecake baked dry cracks down the middle every time, and while a cracked cheesecake tastes identical, you will be upset about it for two days.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment

INGREDIENTS

For the crust and filling

- 2 cups graham cracker crumbs
- 6 tbsp melted butter, 2 tbsp sugar, ½ tsp salt
- 32 oz cream cheese, at room temperature
- 1½ cups sugar
- 4 eggs plus 2 yolks
- 1 cup sour cream
- 2 tbsp vanilla
- 2 tbsp flour, ½ tsp salt

For the caramel and praline

- 1½ cups sugar
- 6 tbsp butter
- ¾ cup heavy cream, warm
- 1½ tsp flaky salt
- 6 oz bacon, cooked crisp and chopped
- ½ cup sugar and 2 tbsp water, for the praline
- ½ cup toasted pecans, chopped

METHOD

- 1.** Press the crumbs, melted butter, sugar, and salt into the bottom and 1 inch up the sides of a 9-inch springform. Bake at 350°F for 10 minutes. Cool, then wrap the outside of the pan in two layers of heavy foil.
- 2.** Beat the cream cheese alone until perfectly smooth, scraping constantly — every lump you leave now is a lump in the finished cake. Add the sugar and beat 3 minutes. Add the eggs and yolks one at a time on low speed, then the sour cream, vanilla, flour, and salt. Do not whip air into it.
- 3.** Pour into the crust, set the pan in a roasting pan, and add boiling water halfway up the sides. Bake at 325°F for 70 to 80 minutes, until the outer two inches are set and the center still wobbles as a single mass.
- 4.** Turn off the oven, crack the door, and leave it an hour. Then refrigerate overnight, uncovered for the first two hours.
- 5.** For the caramel: melt the 1½ cups sugar in a dry pan over medium heat without stirring, swirling occasionally, until deep amber. Off heat, whisk in the butter, then the warm cream — it will erupt, so stand back — then the flaky salt. Cool to room temperature.
- 6.** For the praline: cook the ½ cup sugar with the water to a light amber, stir in the bacon and pecans, and pour onto parchment in a thin sheet. Cool hard, then smash into shards.
- 7.** Unmold the cheesecake, pour the caramel over the top and let it run down the sides, and stand the praline shards up in it just before serving.

F I N A L E

The Abomination



There was really no reason to do this.

The God Is a Dick Burger

SERVES 2, OR 4 REASONABLE PEOPLE • 1 HOUR 15 MINUTES

Two dry-aged patties, bacon, lobster, American cheese, Gruyère, a fried oyster, truffle mayo, and a runny egg, on a buttered challah bun. Served with Parmesan fries cooked in beef tallow.

This is not a good idea and it is not presented as one. Every component is individually excellent and defensible; together they constitute a structure that has to be assembled in a specific order or it will collapse, and eaten in a specific posture or it will fall into your lap. It is the logical endpoint of the preceding two hundred pages and, having arrived there, the only remaining move is to build it once and then never speak of it.

Make it for someone's birthday. Photograph it. Do not make two.

COMMANDMENTS BROKEN

Pork · Shellfish · Meat + Dairy · Questionable Judgment · Everything, essentially

INGREDIENTS

For the fries

- 2 lb russet potatoes, cut into $\frac{3}{8}$ -inch batons
- 2 quarts beef tallow, for frying
- $\frac{3}{4}$ cup finely grated Parmesan
- 2 tbsp chopped parsley, 1 garlic clove grated
- Kosher salt

For the truffle mayo

- $\frac{1}{2}$ cup mayonnaise
- $1\frac{1}{2}$ tsp truffle oil, or 2 tsp truffle paste
- 1 small garlic clove, grated

- 1 tsp lemon juice, black pepper

For the burger

- 1 lb dry-aged ground beef, in four loose 4-oz balls
- 4 slices thick-cut bacon, cooked crisp
- 6 oz cooked lobster meat, warmed in 2 tbsp butter
- 4 shucked oysters, dredged and fried as in the Po' Boy
- 2 slices American cheese
- 2 oz Gruyère, grated
- 2 eggs, fried in butter with runny yolks
- 2 challah buns, split and buttered
- Kosher salt, black pepper

METHOD

- 1.** Soak the cut potatoes in cold water for 30 minutes, then dry them completely. Fry at 300°F for 6 minutes until limp and pale. Drain and rest at least 20 minutes.
- 2.** Whisk the truffle mayo together and refrigerate.
- 3.** Griddle the buttered challah buns cut-side down until deep golden. This bun is carrying more weight than any bun should and it needs the structural toast.
- 4.** Fry the oysters at 375°F for 90 seconds. Drain on a rack, salt immediately, and keep warm.
- 5.** Smash the beef balls in a screaming-hot dry pan, two at a time, pressing hard for 10 seconds. Season, cook 90 seconds, flip, then top two patties with American cheese and two with Gruyère and cook 45 seconds more.
- 6.** Return the fries to 375°F tallow and fry 3 minutes until deep gold. Drain, then toss immediately with the Parmesan, parsley, garlic, and a lot of salt.
- 7.** Assemble in this exact order, bottom to top: truffle mayo, Gruyère patty, bacon, American cheese patty, lobster, fried oysters, fried egg, more truffle mayo, top bun.
- 8.** Press down gently. Spear the whole thing through the center with a long skewer. Cut in half with a serrated knife

in one confident motion. Serve with the fries and a napkin situation that has been thought through in advance.

A note: *There is no wine pairing. There is only a decision, already made.*

Afterword

On the Question of Whether Any of This Was Necessary

No.

But here is the thing that turned up somewhere around the fourth chapter, in the middle of testing a cholent that had no business being as good as it was. This book started as a joke about rules and ended up as a book about technique — because it turns out that when you take a cuisine built on constraint and remove the constraint, what remains isn't chaos. It's the technique. The long braise. The rendered fat. The bread engineered to soak. Every workaround that kashrut forced Jewish cooks to invent is still here, still doing the work, just aimed at a wider target.

Which is a kind of tribute, if you squint. The reason a bacon latke is so good is that the latke was already perfect and the bacon just showed up. The reason lobster carbonara works is that Roman cooks and Ashkenazi cooks independently arrived at the same conclusion about pork fat and starch, and only one group was allowed to write it down.

So: was any of this necessary? No. Neither is most of the good part of being alive. Cook something you'd have to explain, invite people who'll appreciate the explanation, and put too much of it on the table.



Hog sameach.

Index of Commandments Broken

*Every recipe in this book, sorted by the specific rules it violates,
for the reader planning a menu with a theme.*

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Temperatures & Conversions

BACON FAT

1 lb bacon yields roughly $\frac{1}{2}$ to $\frac{2}{3}$ cup rendered fat

BUTTER

1 stick = 8 tbsp = 4 oz = 113 g

OVEN

325°F = 165°C · 350°F = 175°C · 400°F = 205°C · 425°F =
220°C · 500°F = 260°C

BEEF DONENESS

Rare 120°F · Medium-rare 130°F · Medium 140°F

PORK DONENESS

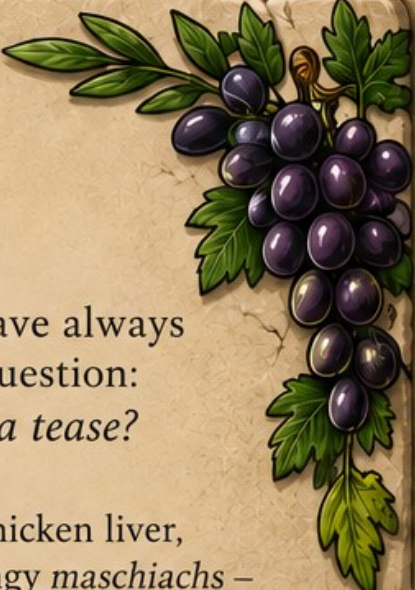
Loin and chops 145°F · Shoulder for shredding 200–205°F

FRYING

Blanch 300°F · Finish 375°F · Never crowd the pot



**G R E A T F O O D · B A D R U L E S · N O
R E G R E T S**



For millennia Jews have always
asked the sacred question:
Why is God such a tease?



From gefilte fish to chicken liver,
from plain parve to mangy *maschiachs* –
we explore the depths of the degrees
to which Hashem has attempted to
deny us delicious delights.

God is a Dick is a delightful
exploration of the many, many ways
in which the devoutly kosher are being
sodomized by Yahweh himself.

The *moschiach* is here —
and he is *shrimp*.



FOOD. HISTORY. NO REGRETS.



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GREAT
FOOD
BAD RULES
NO REGRETS